

HSBC (0005.HK/HSBA.L): 4Q25 first take: Strong beat, robust 2026 guidance, and mid term guidance; Not Rated

HSBC reported 4Q underlying PBT of US\$8.6bn, **13%/9% ahead of GSe/company-compiled consensus** on account of banking NII beat and lower impairments. The robust banking NII benefited from higher HIBOR and a low beta on savings account. Asset quality turned out more resilient than expected with CoC at 37bps with limited HK CRE charges this quarter and better macro assumptions baked in. Costs were largely in-line and so was non banking NII. CET 1 CAR at 14.9% was above expectations. HSBC declared a final dividend of \$0.45 bringing total dividend to \$0.75 higher than consensus of \$0.72.

On HSB following the privatisation, HSBC has announced **total benefits of \$0.9mn**. This comes from: (1) Synergies - Totaling \$0.5bn - \$0.3bn to come from cost synergies (which will be reinvested for growth) with another \$0.2bn coming from revenue synergies which will materialise by 2028. (2) Additional revenue and cost upside of \$0.4bn. HSBC also noted that beyond the \$0.9bn. they see further upside to the privatisation from asset quality improvements and growth opportunities.

HSBC has put out its new 3 year targets:

- Revenue - Rising to 5%yoy growth by 2028 excluding notable items (con 4%/4% for 2026/2027)
- ROTE - 17% or better, excluding notable items, each year (cons 16.6%/17.0% for 2026/2027)
- Dividends - 50% of EPS, excluding material notable items and related impacts

For 2026 guidance, management:

- Bank NII at least \$45bn (cons of \$43.5bn)
- ECL charges of 40bps (cons 40bps)
- Cost at 1% growth on a target basis - this would see cost at \$33.8bn for 2026 (cons \$34.3bn)
- CET1 of 14-15%

A strong beat on the numbers coming from both banking NII and lower provisions. 2026 guidance is above consensus. Based on guidance, consensus should see a 6% upward revision on PBT. 3 year targets are also robust and ahead of consensus. We are Not Rated on HSBA.L and 0005.HK.

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Key highlights:

- **Revenues (+):** Underlying revenues were 4%/3% ahead of GSe/consensus, driven by stronger banking NII. In particular, banking NII for 4Q was US\$11.7bn, which beat by 7%/6%, and non-banking NII was US\$6.0bn, c.-2%/-1% miss. Within Banking NII, it was up +6%/+7% qoq/yoy on constant ccy terms, and c.US\$0.7bn qoq improvement was attributable to higher HIBOR (US\$0.4bn) and specific items (US\$0.1bn) impacting 4Q25 which mgmt do not expect to repeat. Banking NII beat was attributable to better deposit growth (+2% vs. GSe), an upward movement of HIBOR against low beta of saving rate, and re-investment of structural hedges. Non-banking NII was -12%/+4% qoq/yoy on constant ccy terms. Wealth mgmt income was -22%/+20% qoq/yoy, where insurance results growth momentum remained strong at +49% yoy (vs. +46% yoy in 3Q25). NNM for 4Q25 was \$26bn with Asia at \$19bn slightly down from total of \$29bn in 3Q but Asia in 4Q beat 3Q's NNM of \$15bn. Excluding held-for-sale balances, loans and deposits continued to show modest growth with underlying loans +1.6% yoy and deposit formation +3.4% yoy. Based on strong 4Q25 underlying banking NII, mgmt guides at least US\$45bn banking NII in FY26E, +3.4% ahead of consensus ~US\$43.5bn.
- **Costs (=):** Opex was in-line with GSe/consensus (-1%/nil) and grew 6% yoy in 4Q. Full year target basis costs was +3% yoy, in-line with mgmt guidance. Simplification cost savings realized in FY25 was ~US\$0.6bn (vs. ~US\$0.4bn guided at 3Q25), and mgmt expects to realize ~US\$1.3/1.5bn in FY26/27E respectively. Mgmt guides FY26 cost guidance of ~1% growth on target basis.
- **Credit costs (+)** at US\$0.9bn was better than expectations (-19%/-12% vs GS/consensus), benefiting from better-than-expected asset quality of HK CRE portfolio due to macro assumption improvement in HK. During the quarter, HK CRE booked immaterial ECL with NPL ratio at 21% (flat qoq). Full year credit cost was at ~39bp and mgmt guidance for FY26 was at ~40bp.
- **Capital (+):** CET 1 CAR came above expectations at 14.9%. RWAs rose 1% qoq, and were higher than consensus expectations.

Exhibit 1: 4Q25 earnings review

\$mn	4Q25E							Overview			
	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	GSe	Cons	q/q	y/y	act/GS	act/cons
Statutory P&L											
Revenue	11,564	17,649	16,473	17,788	16,364	15,404	15,448	(8%)	42%	6%	6%
Costs	(8,604)	(8,102)	(8,920)	(10,076)	(9,330)	(9,254)	(9,321)	(7%)	8%	1%	0%
Pre-Provision Profit	2,960	9,547	7,553	7,712	7,034	6,150	6,127	(9%)	138%	14%	15%
Impairments	(1,362)	(876)	(1,065)	(1,008)	(901)	(1,117)	(1,020)	(11%)	(34%)	(19%)	(12%)
Operating profit	1,598	8,671	6,488	6,704	6,133	5,033	5,107	(9%)	284%	22%	20%
Associates	679	813	(162)	591	669	556	648	13%	(1%)	20%	3%
PBT - Statutory	2,277	9,484	6,326	7,295	6,802	5,588	5,755	(7%)	199%	22%	18%
Tax Expense	(1,692)	(1,914)	(1,455)	(1,792)	(1,615)	(1,174)	(1,402)	(10%)	(5%)	38%	15%
Profit After Tax	585	7,570	4,871	5,503	5,187	4,415	4,353	(6%)	787%	17%	19%
Non-Controlling interests	(234)	(246)	(138)	(219)	(243)	(225)	(259)	11%	4%	8%	(6%)
Other	(154)	(392)	(155)	(411)	(225)	(154)	(140)	(45%)	46%	46%	61%
Net Income to Ordinary Shareholders	197	6,932	4,578	4,873	4,719	4,036	3,954	(3%)	2295%	17%	19%
Underlying P&L											
Banking NII	10,904	10,599	10,714	11,049	11,722	10,962	11,057	6%	8%	7%	6%
Non banking NII	5,600	7,141	6,943	6,851	6,001	6,141	6,088	(12%)	7%	(2%)	(1%)
Revenue	16,504	17,740	17,657	17,900	17,723	17,104	17,145	(1%)	7%	4%	3%
Costs	(8,498)	(7,911)	(8,268)	(8,380)	(8,905)	(8,954)	(8,920)	6%	5%	(1%)	(0%)
Pre-Provision Profit	8,006	9,829	9,389	9,520	8,818	8,150	8,225	(7%)	10%	8%	7%
Impairments	(1,362)	(876)	(1,065)	(1,008)	(901)	(1,117)	(1,020)	(11%)	(34%)	(19%)	(12%)
Operating profit	6,644	8,953	8,324	8,512	7,917	7,033	7,205	(7%)	19%	13%	10%
Associates	679	813	838	591	669	556	648	13%	(1%)	20%	3%
PBT - Underlying	7,323	9,766	9,162	9,103	8,586	7,588	7,853	(6%)	17%	13%	9%
Key Ratios & Metrics											
RWAs	\$838bn	\$853bn	\$887bn	\$879bn	\$889bn	\$875bn	\$878bn	1%	6%	2%	1%
CET1 ratio	14.9%	14.7%	14.6%	14.5%	14.9%	14.7%	14.7%	0bp	(0bp)	20bp	20bp
Credit cost (bps)	58.5	37.1	43.4	41.0	36.6	45.3	41.6	-	-	-	-
Underlying ROTE	13.2%	18.2%	17.8%	16.7%	15.9%	14.2%	14.6%	(0bp)	0bp	171bp	133bp
EPS	0.01	0.39	0.26	0.28	0.28	0.23	0.23	(1%)	2464%	21%	23%
DPS	0.36	0.10	0.10	0.10	0.45	0.42	0.42	350%	25%	6%	7%
TBVPS	8.61	9.08	9.17	9.22	9.64	9.30	9.38	5%	12%	4%	3%

Source: Company data, Company-compiled consensus, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - HSBC Holdings (0005.HK)

We are Not Rated on 0005.HK.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - HSBC Holdings (HSBA.L)

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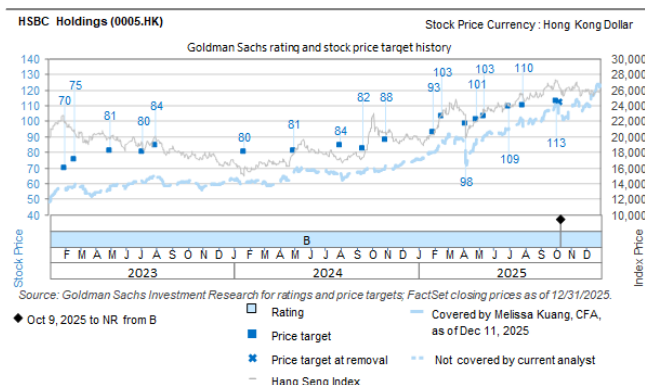
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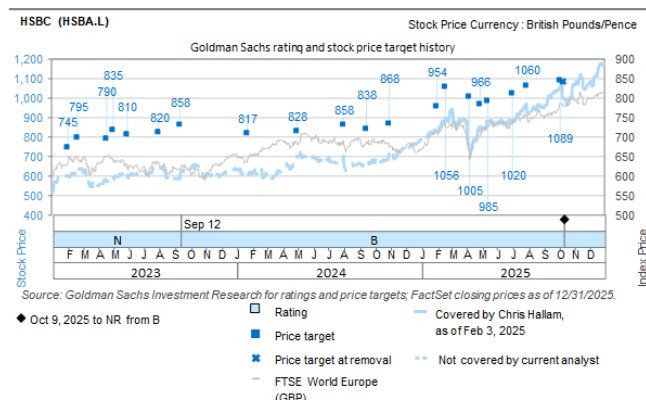
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